

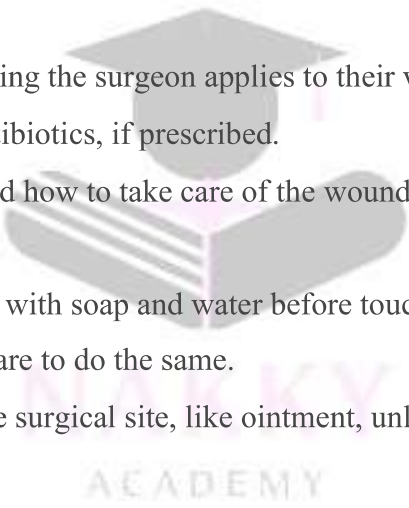
HOW TO PREVENT PATIENTS FROM INFECTIONS AFTER SURGERY?

Before surgery:

- Wash them with an antiseptic cleanser from your doctor before you head to the hospital.
- Don't let them shave, as shaving irritates their skin and can introduce infection under their skin.
- Encourage to quit smoking before they have surgery, as smokers develop more infections. Quitting can be very difficult, but it's possible. Speak to a doctor, who can help them develop a quit smoking plan that's right for them

After your surgery:

- Maintain the sterile dressing the surgeon applies to their wound for at least 48 hours.
- Give them preventive antibiotics, if prescribed.
- Make sure you understand how to take care of the wound, asking questions if you need clarification.
- Always wash your hands with soap and water before touching the wound and ask anyone who may assist in your care to do the same.
- Don't put anything on the surgical site, like ointment, unless your provider tells you to.



Remarkable Nutrients for Recovery After Surgery



After a successful surgery, the medical team that handled the case will prioritize the patient's recovery. The sooner they can get back to normal activities, the better. And while they may not feel like eating, remember that one of the best ways to supercharge their healing is through correct nutrition.

An appropriate post-surgery diet significantly helps in wound healing and provides the patient with adequate energy to do other activities that are essential for their recovery, like physical therapy. Moreover, eating the right kinds of food at the right time is crucial to avoid untoward consequences, such as high blood sugar and constipation, which can complicate their healing.

Foods to avoid after surgery

1. Foods that might cause constipation

The prescription medicines your patient takes to relieve pain together with their general immobility can increase the likelihood of constipation, which can then lead to significant

discomfort (and sometimes even pain). Furthermore, constipation can result in straining – an act that might stress or reopen the incision wounds. Generally, avoid high-fat meats, eggs, dairy products, and sugary sweets, these foods are low in fiber and may lead to constipation.

2. Spicy foods

Spicy foods are also included in the list of foods to avoid after surgery. Surgeons often don't recommend eating spicy foods immediately after surgery because they may upset the stomach. Spices, such as turmeric and ginger (which contain curcumin), can reduce the risk of fatal blood clots. However, too much curcumin might interfere with blood clotting, an important aspect of wound healing.

3. Alcoholic beverages

As much as a surgery can make patients want to drink liquor, alcoholic beverages are one of the foods they shouldn't eat after an operation. This is because alcohol cannot be combined with pain medicines. Additionally, alcohol can trigger dehydration, and after surgery patients need all the hydration they can get to heal quickly.

4. Highly processed foods

Some of the foods patients need to avoid after surgery are those that are highly processed. Not only are they usually low in fiber (which can cause constipation), but in most cases, they also lack the nutrients the body needs to heal. Additionally, many highly-processed foods promote unnecessary inflammation.

Highly processed foods include those sugary drinks, store-bought pastries, candies, chocolates, frozen desserts, fast foods, like fries and hamburgers, and processed meats, such as sausages and deli meats (cold and ready to eat meat).